

Prominent e-commerce portals such as Flipkart.com, Amazon.in, Snapdeal.com, Shopclues.com, PaytmMall.com, and Myntra.com, among others, are the leaders offering discounts on apparel, electronics, and smartphones that could go up to 80%. So how does the average buyer like you know when's the best time to go about hunting for products and earn some sweet cashback, buy-back or exchange options, and easy payment methods?

To further understand how the system works best and how you can track out the ripest moments to buy, we'll take a look at the schedules of big buying festivals that flock the marketplace each year.

### **What, where, and when?**

Understand that everything from clothes to heavy electronics and mobile phones during these sales is discounted. To avoid unmanageable web traffic on a single day, e-commerce websites use various strategies.

Flipkart forks out its biggest sales festival called the Big Billion Days between different categories on different dates. One day you'll find deals on fashion, on another day you'll find deals for home furnishings and large appliances. Flipkart usually keeps offers on the latest mobile phones on the third day along with electronic appliances.

Moving on to the international sector, Amazon sweeps in more buyers by first tempting consumers to opt for its membership programme, Amazon Prime which ties in closely with the annual discount event – the “Great Indian Festival,” exclusively for Prime customers from noon each day between September 21 till September 24. While special discounts exist on appliances, home furniture and general products, Amazon Prime subscribers can get up an extra 20% drop over and above existing offers.

Coming back to local brands, ShopClues too runs a similar “Maha Bharat Diwali Sale” which, despite swift competition from competitors, runs during the same period as many others, from September 20 till September 28. ShopClues runs several raffle draws and point reward programs to ensure that buyers always circle back to the same spot instead of leaving.

Myntra similarly hosts “The End Of Reason” sale allowing discounts during longer periods but with greater cash back during month ends and national festivals. Always be sure to graze the website a day later than the ad banners start making their way to YouTube to avoid being ripped off by high early stock prices.

Now coming to a whole new channel that buyers may be unaware of, The country's largest digital payment service Paytm hosted the “Mera